

Youssef Awad

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Summary

Engineer who builds production systems powered by LLMs (multi-agent orchestration, RAG, evals, and autonomous agents), backed by an offensive-security foundation (OSCP). Co-founded CTFae and built the infrastructure behind the world's largest CTF: 10,000+ concurrent users, a Guinness World Record, and Best Emirati Startup at GISEC 2024. I solve real problems with code, automate the boring parts, and ship things people rely on, then threat-model them like an attacker.

Professional Experience

Head of Engineering & Co-Founder | CTFae – Dubai, UAE 2021 – Present

- Architected Challenge Deployment API (Python/FastAPI) for on-demand provisioning of containerized challenges to AWS ECS with auto-scaling, serving 10,000+ concurrent participants at BlackHat MEA (Guinness World Record 2024).
- Built CyberRanges IaC platform (Terraform, Packer, Ansible) for automated multi-VM attack-defense environments across AWS and GCP, plus CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions and OIDC.
- Developed Attack-Defense checksystem with Python/Celery, PostgreSQL (PgCat pooling), and Redis for real-time scoring of 100+ teams simultaneously.
- Led engineering for DEFCON 33 Bug Bounty CTF, GITEX Dubai, Bahrain National CTF, BSides Nashville, HITB, and Dubai Police CTF.

Senior Cyber Security Consultant | Malcrove – Dubai, UAE 2022 – Dec 2025

- Conducted penetration testing for UAE government and critical-infrastructure clients across web/mobile applications, internal/external networks, and wireless systems.
- Achieved over 90% success rate in obtaining Domain Admin privileges across 100+ Active Directory engagements.
- Authored CVSS-scored vulnerability reports with proof-of-concept exploits and remediation guidance; presented executive summaries to non-technical leadership.

AI & Agentic Projects

- **ProjectHailMary** – Solo-operated agentic vulnerability finder: one orchestrator drives 60+ charter-bearing subagents through a validation gauntlet (trace, PoC, CVSS, dedup) into a deterministic CLEAR/HOLD/REJECT verdict. 23 modules, 465+ tests. (Python)
- **LLM-AD-Defense** – Autonomous SOC analyst on Gemini 2.5 Pro: ingests Wazuh EDR alerts and executes its own remediation, including isolating compromised Active Directory accounts. (Python/FastAPI)
- **LLMChessArena** (live) – Any LLM vs any LLM over OpenRouter, with real-time WebSocket streaming, move-by-move Stockfish evaluation, and per-move token/cost tracking. (TypeScript)

Technical Skills

Applied AI / LLMs: LLM integration, multi-agent orchestration, RAG, evals & guardrails, prompt engineering, OpenRouter, Claude, Gemini

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Bash, SQL

Cloud/DevOps: Docker, Terraform, Ansible, Packer, GitHub Actions, AWS (ECS, ECR, IAM), GCP

Backend & Web: FastAPI, Hono, Flask, Express, React, Next.js, Vite, Tailwind, PostgreSQL, Redis, RabbitMQ, Celery, Pydantic, SQLAlchemy, Nginx, Linux

Security: Penetration Testing, Red Teaming, Active Directory, Vulnerability Assessment, CTF Development

Education & Certifications

B.Sc. Computer Engineering (Minor: Computer Science) – American University of Sharjah, UAE 2017 – 2022

OSCP – Offensive Security Certified Professional (Score: 90/100)

Awards

- **Guinness World Record (2024):** Largest CTF competition in the world – BlackHat MEA
- **Best Community Engagement (2025):** UAE CyberSecurity Awards • **Best Emirati Startup (2024):** GISEC UAE
- **12+ CTF Wins:** CyberBattle of Emirates, Dubai Police CTF, CyberTalents UAE, HITB Lockdown, CyberQuest